years enabled it to avoid crushing sanctions and a harsh state action. It disassociated itself from LeT based in IHK, although its moral and material support did not stop entirely. It stopped propagating its actions in Pakistan through its media. It adopted this strategy to avoid annihilation in the wake of immense local and foreign pressure after its alleged involvement in the Mumbai attacks. It seemed to have learnt lessons from Ikhwanul Muslimeen in Egypt and Hizbullah in Lebanon, which changed their course and approach to become mainstream political parties.

During an interview with Khalid Bashir, Coordinator Public Relations, JuD, it was found that he did not express any disgust over the Mumbai attacks on the television. However, according to LeT/JuD magazines, LeT termed the television as the devil's workshop, which polluted the minds of the youth. Its young members were encouraged to smash the TV sets at their homes. The stories of many young members who had smashed their television sets were published with great pride. Khalid Bashir stated that it was the policy of the past. He further added that JuD had given up its hatred towards TV after consulting the Muslim Ulema (religious scholars) and that the TV was no longer a taboo or '*haram*' (religiously forbidden) now.[7]

Political aspirations and pragmatic reasons seemed to have overshadowed strict religious or ideological stance. Hafiz Saeed, who was media-shy initially (Mir, 2009), later started giving interviews to TV channels. And he was frequently photographed during his public meetings. Although this change might have gone unnoticed by many, in fact, it depicted a sea change in the approach of the Chief of LeT.

Although Hafiz Saeed was suffering from flu and fever on the day of the meeting, he was perked up.[8] The statement of the Indian Home Secretary that Indian Hindu extremists were responsible for a lot of terrorist acts in India refreshed him (Zee TV, 2009).[9] He was feeling relieved and vindicated and somehow appreciated the Prime Minister of India for backing the revealing statement of the Home Minister. However, he talked less about India and more about the internal unrest and security situation in Pakistan. He lamented the deplorable security situation in Karachi and suggested that politicians should forget about the general elections (scheduled to be held in April/May 2013) for at least some time and focus on eradicating violence and terrorism in